

FIND YOUR WHY

(Sermon Four)

TEXT: Luke 1:26-35 (NKJV) *“Now in the sixth month the angel Gabriel was sent by God to a city of Galilee named Nazareth, ²⁷ to a virgin betrothed to a man whose name was Joseph, of the house of David. The virgin’s name was Mary. ²⁸ And having come in, the angel said to her, “Rejoice, highly favored one, the Lord is with you; blessed are you among women!” ²⁹ But when she saw him, she was troubled at his saying, and considered what manner of greeting this was. ³⁰ Then the angel said to her, “Do not be afraid, Mary, for you have found favor with God. ³¹ And behold, you will conceive in your womb and bring forth a Son, and shall call His name Jesus. ³² He will be great, and will be called the Son of the Highest; and the Lord God will give Him the throne of His father David. ³³ And He will reign over the house of Jacob forever, and of*

His kingdom there will be no end.”³⁴ Then Mary said to the angel, “How can this be, since I do not know a man?”³⁵ And the angel answered and said to her, “The Holy Spirit will come upon you, and the power of the Highest will overshadow you; therefore, also, that Holy One who is to be born will be called the Son of God.”

INTRO: You may be wondering what in the world the Christmas story has to do with your “WHY”. There are three things in this passage that will determine whether we discover and live out our “WHY”:

- The Word for the Why...
- The Favor for the Why...
- The Obedience to live out the Why...

THE WORD FOR THE WHY

In modern church culture everyone wants a Word from the Lord. Some people will travel half way around the world to get a Word from the Lord.

Make no mistake about it, a Word from the Lord is essential to our “WHY”. There will be no “WHY” without a Word from the Lord.

I agree, that a Word from the Lord is important in various seasons of our lives, but the truth is we have His Word in writing – It is called the Bible:

- 66 books...
- 1,189 chapters...
- 23,145 verses...
- 783,137 words...
- 1,050 commands...
- 8,810 promises... (7,487 are direct promises from God to humankind)

When we need a Word, we should go to the written Word first. All other words we receive should do two things:

- Confirm what the Lord has already been saying to us...
- Agree with the Word He has already given to us in the Bible...

Charles Spurgeon said, “*A bible that is falling apart usually belongs to someone who is not.*”

When we have a word from the Lord, we should treat it as a sacred trust. Psalm 119:11 “***Thy word have I hid in my heart that I might not sin against you.***” Many people know the Word but continue to sin. If one can read and understand the Word, yet continue to sin, what is this scripture speaking of? Let’s break this scripture down a bit:

- “***Word***” = Hebrew – Imrah – The Greek word is Rhema. These words are different than the Hebrew word Dabar, which in the Greek is Logos. Imrah is a personal, particular, whispered word. It is a secret conversation from the Lord’s lips, to our ears. These Hebrew and Greek words are not to be confused with the Hebrew word Dabar, which in Greek is Logos. Logos is a general word – Its principles are for all - The Commandments are a Dabar, Logos word – A Dabar, Logos word is a universal word –

It is a written word - It is a word that must be proclaimed... Make no mistake about it, the Dabar, Logos word is powerful and must be center stage in the life of one who wishes to live out there “WHY”, but the Imrah, Rhema word has a powerful place as well for those who hope to discover and live out their “WHY”. Mary knew the Logos Word, but it was the Rhema Word that made this radical adjustment to her life, and caused her to live out her “WHY”.

- **“*Hid*”** = In the Hebrew this word is Taman and in the Greek it is Thesaurus - What is a thesaurus? It’s a treasury of words. A thesaurus is all the words in a language - The antonyms The synonyms -The nouns – The adjectives – The verbs – The Adverbs – The writer is saying, *“I take all of your Amrah, Rhema words and put them in the safety deposit box of my heart...”* We don’t place junk in a safety deposit boxes, we place highly valuable documents in our safety deposit box – Susan and I keep a

written copy of all Rhema words – They create a sacred echo.

- The writer say's, I do this so that I will not “**Sin**” against Him – “**Sin**” = The Hebrew word is Chatta, and in the Greek it is Hamartia – This simply means “*To miss the mark.*” - We could paraphrase this scripture to say, “*My divine design that you have spoken to me, I have treasured it in my innermost being, so that I might not miss the bullseye of your purpose and calling on my life, that you have declared to me.*”

This scripture is saying that “*If we treat His Word as a sacred trust, it will cause our lives to be directed into the purpose He has for us.*”

Mary treated the WORD from the angel as a sacred trust and it became the guiding principle for her life for the next thirty-five years!

THE FAVOR FOR THE WHY

When Gabriel told Mary she was “*highly favored*” he used the Greek word Charitoo.

Charitoo means:

- Grace...
- Delight...
- Pleasure...
- Goodwill...
- Lovingkindness...

The only other place this word is used is in Ephesians 1:6 “*To the praise of his glorious grace, with which he has blessed us in the Beloved.*” We could paraphrase this to say, “*Through His glorious grace, He has Charitooed us in the beloved.*” Without offending our former or current Catholic friends, the same favor that was on Mary to become the vehicle that brought God’s purpose into the earth, is the exact same favor upon our “WHY”.

Have you ever thought of yourself as someone as special as Mary? If not, why not? We are just

like Mary! We have been chosen to carry the seed of His purpose (Our WHY), and to birth it in the earth!

God has Charitooed us in Christ!

We have been chosen to carry our own Rhema word! That whispered, specific word, that we have hidden in my heart, and give birth to it in the earth!

We have been given the favor to carry out our “WHY”, the question is, will we?

THE OBEDIENCE TO LIVE OUT THE WHY

Notice that Mary “*Pondered this*” – Where? “*In her heart!*” “*Thy word have I hid in my heart that I might not sin against thee.*”

Our hearts are where the battle for our “WHY” is won or lost! Once Mary “*Pondered* –

Considered – this in her heart” she said, ***“Be it unto me according to thy (Rhema) Word....”***

No rhema word will ever be given without the Dunamis to carry it out!!!!!!!!!!

The reason Mary pondered this in her heart is because she was ***“troubled”*** by the words the angel was speaking. This doesn’t mean she was upset by the words of the angel, it means *“she was surprised to hear such extravagant words said to her and about her.”*

Mary was being asked to be obedient to an extravagant word being spoken over her life. Right here, she was being introduced to her “WHY”.

Think of this, Mary’s “WHY” would be to take on the role of the matriarch of the savior’s lineage! To be the mother to God, playing a role as the savior of the world! No pressure!

Mary didn't have to:

- Pray concerning her decision...
- Council with the Rabbi...
- Get the intercessors involved...
- Do any research to make her decision...
- Get back to the angel about it...
- Have a church business meeting to vote on it...

She simply became obedient to her “WHY”, and a peasant girl from Nazareth, who would have lived and died in obscurity, is made world famous by her “WHY”. Now 2,000 years later, I am preaching about her thousands of miles from Nazareth in the world class city of Houston, Texas.

Here is where we get involved... Everything we have talked about up until this point, God did on His own... We can all agree on the wonder of such an extravagant word being spoken over a peasant girl from Nazareth... BUT our “WHY” carries the Rhema Word from the same God!

We are chosen by Almighty God to carry out our own extravagant, Rhema Word, in the earth!

- Do we know what that word is in our lives?
- Do we want to know what that word is in our lives?
- Are we willing to obediently to carry out the “WHY” no matter how extravagant it seems to be?

God has:

A Word for our “WHY”...

The Favor for our “WHY”...

The discovery of, and obedience to live out our “WHY” is totally on us!

CONCLUSION:

Mary:

- Exhibited Faith...
- Received the Word from the angel...
- Endured suspicion and ridicule...
- Birthed the Word in due time...

- Walked out the process of raising Jesus...
- Never received a second Word from the angel...

Mary received one Word from the angel and followed it for 33 1/2 years! She never went to another meeting looking for someone to “*confirm*” the word of the Lord to her!

How many words are we going to need before we discover our “WHY” and walk it out?